

**Medford Public Schools
Sub-committee Meeting Minutes
Equity Policy and Rules Sub-committee
December 9, 2020 Via Zoom**

4:03 pm Call to Order
 Sub-committee Chair: Paul Ruseau

Present: Members: Jenny Graham, Melanie McLaughlin, and Paul Ruseau

Purpose: To continue building the school calendar 2021/2022 with particular attention paid to observance of holidays.

Other people attending: Patrick Hunter, Peter Cushing, Tom Milaschewski, Suzi Weiss, Lisa Evangelista, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent , Joan Bowen

Link to School Year/School Calendar policy was sent out by Paul Ruseau prior to the meeting.

Change in policy is to change approval to November of the previous year.

Observance list newly added. Naming of each holiday is to be done with determination of N: no school B: blocked (no tests/projects assigned, no events to be scheduled whenever possible), E: excused absence

Jenny Graham: How wide a net in saying no events associated with Medford Public Schools when it comes to blocked?

Paul Ruseau: with over 300 events per year, it is hard to determine. So many clubs scheduling events. If we start with "when possible" we can work from there. Maybe a higher level of restriction will be added in the future. By publishing a list every year, it gives people a chance to consider scheduling around holidays.

Jenny Graham: When we publish the list, I am thinking we will add the dates and then sort appropriately. Voting dates might need to be included to this list so people can plan accordingly.

Paul Ruseau: There could be a lot of dates but good to consider.

Jenny Graham: when we publish the list each year, we can include them.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: Since this never existed in this format, this will be super helpful to provide to teachers, coaches and principals. We can definitely tell them to keep these dates in mind.

Paul Ruseau: I may need to add more holidays (Sikh, Native Americans) and include a note making reference to some days being overlooked.

Melanie McLaughlin: I would like to add Autism Awareness day, April 2 and Down syndrome Awareness Day on March 21.

Paul Ruseau: Are there any other questions, comments or suggestions?

Melanie McLaughlin: I like the idea of asking for community feedback. I am sure there will be a knee jerk reaction to the list where people feel their holidays are not included.

Motion to Approve: Three in the affirmative. Policy recommendations will be sent to the next school committee.

Motion to Adjourn: MM, JG second. Three affirmative. The meeting adjourned at 4:26PM.